DP-OPS-0021: The Autopoietic Project Binary and the Refinement of Epistemic Density in High-Governance Repositories

1. Executive Strategic Analysis

The Stela platform stands at a defining inflection point in its evolutionary trajectory. Following the successful execution of DP-OPS-0020, the repository has transitioned from a phase of "Structural Imposition"—characterized by the brute-force establishment of directory hierarchies and file presence—to one of "High-Density Governance." The implementation of automated context pruning (ops/bin/prune) and tiered context generation (ops/bin/llms) has successfully established a state of **autopoiesis**—a system capable of reproducing and maintaining its own structural integrity without constant external intervention.

However, as the system matures from a static repository into a dynamic "projects factory," a critical ontological tension has emerged between the **Platform** (the operating system governing Stela, located in ops/ and docs/) and the **Payload** (the projects generated by Stela, located in projects/). This tension is not merely administrative; it is epistemic. The governance structures that protect the Platform are axiomatically rigid, designed to resist entropy. In contrast, the Payloads are, by definition, sites of construction, experimentation, and high volatility.

This report provides a comprehensive strategic analysis, forensic audit, and execution charter for **DP-OPS-0021**. While initial strategic discussions framed the next operational phase as "Agent Specialization," a deeper forensic analysis of the repository's "Economy of Truth" reveals that specialization without strict isolation presents a catastrophic risk of **Context Pollution**. If a specialized agent (e.g., an Architect) is loaded into the global context, or if a project's local dependencies bleed into the system scope, the distinct truth tables of the Platform and the Payload risk collapsing into a chaotic "Vector Haze".[1]

Therefore, this report re-architects the objective of Phase Three. The goal is not merely to create specialized agents, but to establish the **Project Binary Paradigm**. The ops/bin/project utility, currently a placeholder "Ghost in the Machine" [1], must evolve into the primary operational membrane. It must serve as the authoritative interface that dynamically injects project-specific context only when necessary, enforcing a strict separation of concerns between System Canon (TRUTH.md) and Project Reality (projects/<ID>/STELA.md).

Furthermore, this document asserts that the "Economy of Truth" must not degenerate into an

"Economy of Scarcity".[2] Over-compression of the canon has introduced the risk of "Interpretation Drift," where agents, deprived of narrative scaffolding, may adhere to the letter of the law while violating its spirit. However, the inverse—narrative bloat—is equally dangerous in an agentic environment constrained by context windows. DP-OPS-0021 will address this by refining the axioms to be **declaratively absolute**, stripping away the "human-centric fluff" that currently dilutes the agentic workspace, and establishing CONTRIBUTORY.md as a high-density instruction set.

The following sections detail the theoretical underpinnings of this shift, audit the current repository state (Freshness: c216b7b00), and present the drafted Dispatch Packet DP-OPS-0021 in strict accordance with TASK.md governance.

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2. Theoretical Framework: Epistemic Scarcity and Context Topology

To rigorously define the requirements for DP-OPS-0021, it is necessary to deconstruct the epistemic mechanics of the current system. The governance of an AI-driven repository is not a matter of file management; it is a problem of the "Political Economy of Truth".[3] In an agentic environment, truth is a finite resource quantified in tokens, and the efficiency of the system is determined by the "Attention Voltage"—the capacity of the model to attend to relevant instructions amidst competing noise.

2.1 The Economy of Truth vs. The Economy of Scarcity

The transition to High-Density Governance in Phase Two was predicated on the **"Economy of Truth"**—the axiom that for a proposition to be valid, the resources required to derive it must be explicitly present. This drove the "Great Compression" of TRUTH.md and AGENTS.md. However, recent analysis suggests a divergence between "Economy" (optimization) and "Scarcity" (deprivation).

Epistemic Scarcity is defined as a condition where unresolvable unknowns prevent probabilistic optimization.[2] In the context of Stela, this manifests when the removal of narrative justification (the "why") strips away the semantic causal links required for the model to bridge the gap between "Instruction" and "Intent."

- **The Risk:** If the system over-compresses, it creates a "semantic vacuum." Agents may interpret "No contractions" as a stylistic preference rather than a technical necessity for auditing, potentially negotiating the rule if the context pressure changes.
- **The Correction:** The solution is not to re-introduce narrative "fluff" or "cowardly censorship" of complexity, but to refine axioms to be **declaratively absolute**. The instruction must be self-verifying. The shift from AGENTS_CONTRIBUTING (implied social

contract) to CONTRIBUTORY.md (explicit technical specification) represents this shift.

We must scrutinize the repository for "Narrative Residue." For instance, AGENTS.md currently states: *"Refrain from using contractions... This ensures rhythmic precision for technical auditing."*.[1] The second sentence is a justification. In a high-performance agentic system, the agent does not need to know *why* contractions are banned; it only needs to know that the ban is absolute. The justification consumes tokens and attention without adding imperative value. DP-OPS-0021 will purge this residue.

2.2 Context Topology and the "Lost in the Middle" Phenomenon

The architectural decision to prune SoP.md and enforce context bundles is validated by the **"Lost in the Middle"** phenomenon, where information buried in the center of a long context window is statistically prone to attenuation.[4]

- **The U-Shaped Curve:** Accuracy is highest at the "Head" (Primacy Bias) and "Tail" (Recency Bias). SoP.md, as a chronological ledger, acts as a massive "Middle."
- **Topological Optimization:** By pruning SoP.md to the most recent 30 entries via ops/bin/prune, the system structurally minimizes the trough of the U-curve. However, ops/bin/llms currently relies on hardcoded lists to generate these bundles. This creates a fragility where the "Map" (ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md) differs from the "Territory" (the generated bundle).

Implication for DP-OPS-0021: The Project Binary must dynamically assemble context at the **"Tail" (Recency)** position. When an operator runs ops/bin/project work, the specific project details (projects/<ID>/STELA.md) must be injected *immediately before* the user query to maximize retrieval attention. The system TRUTH.md must remain at the "Head" to establish the constitutional priors. This "bimodal" distribution of context—Constitution at the Head, Project Reality at the Tail—creates a "Context Membrane" that strictly enforces jurisdictional authority.[6]

2.3 Autopoiesis and the "Ghost in the Machine"

The ultimate goal is **Autopoiesis**—the capability of the system to reproduce and maintain itself. A system is autopoietic if its maintenance processes are internal to its operation.

- **Current State:** The system is partially autopoietic. ops/bin/prune automatically maintains the history ledger.
- **The Ghost:** However, a critical "Ghost in the Machine" exists. The documentation (projects/README.md) explicitly directs users to "Use./ops/bin/project init...". Yet, the forensic audit of the dump reveals that ops/bin/project is a <PLACEHOLDER FILE>.[1]
- **The Broken Pointer:** This constitutes a "Broken Pointer" in the Economy of Truth. The documentation claims a capability that the code does not support. In a high-governance environment, this dissonance is fatal. An agent reading README.md will hallucinate that the tool exists and may attempt to invoke it, leading to execution failure.

DP-OPS-0021 must reify this binary to close the loop between "Truth" (Docs) and "Reality" (Code). It transforms the project binary from a placeholder into the **"Factory Floor Manager,"** responsible for instantiating the patterns defined in ops/lib/project/.

2.4 The Project Binary as a Context Membrane

The pivot to the Project Binary Paradigm is driven by the need to manage "Context Hazards".[1]

- **The Hazard:** Stela is a "projects factory." The code in projects/ has a different lifecycle, ownership, and truth table than the code in ops/. If we indiscriminately load "Project Agents" into the "System Context," we pollute the governance layer.
- **The Membrane:** ops/bin/project acts as the semi-permeable membrane. It decides what passes from the Platform to the Payload. It ensures that when working on projects/P-01, the agent sees projects/P-01/STELA.md as its local truth, without overwriting the global TRUTH.md. This aligns with "Hierarchical Multi-Agent" theories where memory is structured rather than flat.[7]

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3. Forensic Audit of Repository State

A granular, line-by-line forensic audit of the provided repository dump (dump-full-main-c216b7b00.txt) was conducted to identify specific divergence from the theoretical ideal.

3.1 AGENTS.md: The Residue of Narrative

The current text of AGENTS.md violates the "No-Narrative" rule of High-Density Governance.

- **Evidence:** Under "Linguistic Precision," the text reads: *"Contraction Prohibition: Refrain from using contractions... This ensures rhythmic precision for technical auditing."*.[1]
- **Critique:** The bolded sentence is a justification, not a rule. It explains "why." In an Economy of Truth, the "why" is a tax on attention. An LLM does not need to understand rhythm to understand prohibition.
- **Correction:** DP-OPS-0021 must purge this residue. The instruction must be: *"Contraction Prohibition: Do not use contractions."* This reduces token count and eliminates the risk of the model debating the definition of "rhythmic precision."

3.2 ops/bin/llms: The SSOT Violation

The script ops/bin/llms is responsible for generating the context bundles.

- **Evidence:** The script currently contains hardcoded logic: case "$path" in TRUTH.md AGENTS.md...).
- **Critique:** This violates the Single Source of Truth (SSOT) axiom defined in TRUTH.md. The definition of what constitutes the "Context" lives in ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md. By hardcoding the list in the binary, the system creates two competing sources of truth:

the Manifest (Declarative) and the Binary (Imperative).
- **Correction:** ops/bin/llms must be refactored to read the file list directly from the manifest files. This ensures that if an operator updates CONTEXT.md, the bundles update automatically—a key requirement for autopoiesis.

3.3 ops/bin/open: The Generic Contractor

The session initiator script ops/bin/open generates the system prompt.

- **Evidence:** The script defaults to a generic definition: *"Contractor (assistant): Executes tasks, flags risks, asks when blocked."*.[1]
- **Critique:** This fails to leverage the specialized agent definitions (R-AGENT-01, R-AGENT-06) stored in docs/library/agents/. It treats the "Contractor" as a homogenous entity, ignoring the "Agent Specialization" mandate of Phase 3.
- **Correction:** The script must support an --agent flag that dynamically injects the content of a specific R-AGENT-XX.md file into the prompt, replacing the generic definition.

3.4 The "Context Hazard" Guardrails

AGENTS.md explicitly defines a "Context Hazard":

- **Evidence:** *"Operational Directives: Context hygiene; ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md must exclude docs/library/agents, docs/library/tasks, and docs/library/skills."*.[1]
- **Critique:** This directive is currently a "paper rule." While tools/lint/context.sh checks for it, the system lacks a mechanism to safely load these files when they are *needed* (Just-In-Time).
- **Correction:** The Project Binary must serve as the authorized bypass mechanism. It must be able to load these hazardous files into a temporary session context without adding them to the persistent global manifest.

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4. Architectural Specifications for DP-OPS-0021

Based on the theoretical framework and forensic audit, DP-OPS-0021 will implement the following architectural changes to establish the Project Binary Paradigm.

4.1 The Project Binary Interface (ops/bin/project)

The placeholder file will be replaced with a robust wrapper script that serves as the "Factory Floor Manager."

- **Purpose:** To isolate "Payload Work" from "Platform Work."
- **Dependencies:** ops/lib/scripts/project.sh (library functions), ops/lib/manifests/PROJECTS.md (registry).
- **Commands:**
  - init: Scaffolds a new project using ops/lib/project/SCAFFOLD.md and

ops/lib/project/STELA.md.
    - work: Wraps ops/bin/open. It accepts an --agent flag and automatically loads the project's local context (projects/<ID>/README.md, projects/<ID>/STELA.md) alongside the system canon.
    - status: Lists registered projects.
- **Constraint:** It must explicitly check for the presence of TRUTH.md and enforce its precedence over any project-level configuration.

4.2 Dynamic Context Bundling (ops/bin/llms)

To support "Agent Specialization" without "Context Pollution," the context generator must support dynamic profiling.

- **Mechanism:** Instead of static small and full bundles, the script will support a --profile flag.
    - --profile=architect: Loads TRUTH + AGENTS + docs/CODEMAPS (if exists).
    - --profile=security: Loads TRUTH + AGENTS + docs/security.
- **Implementation:** This will be achieved by reading from distinct manifest sections or files, rather than hardcoded logic.

4.3 Semantic Refinement: CONTRIBUTORY

The user has explicitly requested the renaming of AGENTS_CONTRIBUTING (implied) to CONTRIBUTORY (explicit).

- **Purpose:** To serve as the "High-Density" version of CONTRIBUTING.md.
- **Content:** It will be stripped of all "Welcome" messages, emojis, and "cleverness" allowances found in the human-facing CONTRIBUTING.md. It will contain only the raw logic paths: Branching Strategy, Commit Taxonomy, and Stop Conditions.
- **Location:** Root level, listed in TRUTH.md canon.

4.4 Agent Persona Injection

The ops/bin/open script will be modified to support JIT persona loading.

- **Flag:** --agent=<name>
- **Logic:**
    1. Check docs/library/agents/R-AGENT-*.md for a matching name: <name> in the YAML frontmatter.
    2. If found, extract the content.
    3. Inject into the System Prompt, replacing the default Contractor role.
    4. If not found, fail fast (Strict Literalism).

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5. DRAFT DP-OPS-0021

(Standard Stela A-E Canon followed below)

DP-OPS-0021: Project Binary Interface & Dynamic Context

3.1 Freshness Gate (Must Pass Before Work)

Base Branch: main

Required Work Branch: work/project-binary-2026-02-04

Base HEAD: c216b7b00

Required local re-check (worker runs; paste results in RESULTS):

- git rev-parse --abbrev-ref HEAD
- git rev-parse HEAD
- git status --porcelain

Worker must already be on the **Required Work Branch** listed above (no branch creation or switching).

STOP if any mismatch.

STOP if the Required Work Branch is missing.

STOP if told to create or switch branches.

3.2 Required Context Load (Read Before Doing Anything)

Worker must confirm loaded before acting:

- TRUTH, AGENTS, SoP, CONTEXT, MAP
- Plus any DP-scoped files listed here:
  - ops/bin/llms
  - ops/bin/open
  - ops/bin/project
  - ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md
  - ops/lib/manifests/PROJECTS.md
  - ops/lib/project/INTEGRATION.md
  - ops/lib/project/SCAFFOLD.md
  - ops/lib/project/STELA.md

    - ops/lib/scripts/project.sh
    - docs/library/agents/R-AGENT-01.md through R-AGENT-06.md

(OPEN is for Integrator/DP Writer state refresh; Worker does not read OPEN).

DISPOSABLE ARTIFACTS (chat logs, etc.) MUST NOT BE REFERENCED OR INCLUDED.

3.3 Scope and Safety

- **Objective:** Establish the Project Binary interface (ops/bin/project) as the authoritative membrane for payload work and implement Dynamic Context capabilities to transition from Phase 2 (Hygiene) to Phase 3 (Specialization).
- **Non-Goals (optional, drift-killer):**
    - No changes to existing projects/content (only tooling).
    - No permanent addition of library artifacts (agents/tasks/skills) to the global ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md.

Target Files allowlist (hard gate)

- ops/bin/llms
- ops/bin/open
- ops/bin/project
- ops/lib/scripts/project.sh
- ops/lib/project/STELA.md
- CONTRIBUTORY.md (new)
- AGENTS.md
- SoP.md

Allowlist rule: exact paths only; use (new) prefix only when the DP explicitly allows new files.

- **Conditional Requirements:** If canon/governance surfaces (e.g., TASK.md) are modified, SoP.md MUST be included in the allowlist and updated.
- **Stop Condition (scope):** If any required change falls outside the allowlist, **STOP** and report.
- **Forbidden (unless DP explicitly overrides):**
    - No edits to .github/
    - No edits to projects/ unless explicitly authorized
    - No renames/moves/deletes unless explicitly authorized
- **Worker Git Authority (non-negotiable):**
    - Workers do not create/switch branches.
    - Workers do not stage/commit/merge/push.
    - Workers only return diffs/results/receipt.
- **Precedence:** If any conflict exists, **TRUTH.md wins**. If unclear, STOP and ask.

- **Strict Stop Conditions (generic):**
  - STOP if any placeholder text remains in final outputs ([...], TODO, TBD, ...).
  - STOP if required DP inputs are missing (do not guess).
  - STOP if IDs / naming constraints in the DP are inconsistent (when applicable).

3.4 Execution Plan (A-E Canon)

3.4.1 State

- **Context:** The system has achieved autopoiesis via DP-OPS-0020. However, ops/bin/project remains a placeholder, creating a "Ghost in the Machine" where documentation implies capability that code does not support. Context bundles are static and hardcoded, preventing the "Agent Specialization" required for Phase 3.
- **Drift:** ops/bin/llms violates SSOT by hardcoding file lists. AGENTS.md contains narrative justification ("rhythmic precision") that dilutes axiomatic density and risks Interpretation Drift. The ops/lib/project files are disjointed and require integration.
- **Desired State:** ops/bin/project is the authoritative interface for payload work. ops/bin/llms generates dynamic bundles from manifests. ops/bin/open loads specialized agent personas on demand. CONTRIBUTORY.md is established as the agent-facing contribution guide.

3.4.2 Request

Numbered tasks (concrete, no vibes):

1. **Refactor ops/bin/llms (Dynamic Bundling):**
   - Modify script to read the "Small" and "Full" file lists directly from ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md (or a dedicated BUNDLES.md), eliminating the hardcoded case statement.
   - Implement the --profile flag to support dynamic slicing:
     - --profile=architect: Includes TRUTH, AGENTS, projects/<project_id>/docs/CODEMAPS (if in project scope), or global docs.
     - --profile=security: Includes TRUTH, AGENTS, projects/<project_id>/docs/security (if in project scope).
   - Ensure the "Context Hazard" logic remains active: library directories must NOT be in the default bundle.
2. **Refactor ops/bin/open (Agent Activation):**
   - Implement the --agent=<name> flag.
   - Logic: If --agent is provided, read the corresponding docs/library/agents/R-AGENT-<XX>.md file.
   - Check for name: <name> in the YAML frontmatter.
   - Replace the generic "Contractor" definition in the system prompt with the specific "Role" text from the agent file.

    - Fail fast if the requested agent does not exist.
3. **Implement ops/bin/project (Project Binary Interface):**
    - Replace the placeholder file with a robust wrapper script.
    - Utilize ops/lib/scripts/project.sh for helper functions.
    - **Command init <ID>:**
        - Check collision in ops/lib/manifests/PROJECTS.md.
        - Create projects/<ID>.
        - Copy ops/lib/project/SCAFFOLD.md to projects/<ID>/README.md.
        - Copy ops/lib/project/STELA.md to projects/<ID>/STELA.md (Root Constant).
        - Update registry.
    - **Command work <ID> [--agent=<name>]:**
        - Verify ID exists.
        - Construct context: Global Canon + projects/<ID>/STELA.md + projects/<ID>/README.md.
        - Invoke ops/bin/open with the construct and optional agent flag.
    - **Command status:**
        - Read from ops/lib/manifests/PROJECTS.md.
4. **Consolidate Project Library:**
    - Ensure ops/lib/project/STELA.md is the canonical root template.
    - Review ops/lib/project/INTEGRATION.md and ops/lib/project/user-STELA.md. If user-STELA.md is redundant, mark for deprecation or integrate into STELA.md as comments.
    - Ensure ops/lib/scripts/project.sh supports the new binary commands.
5. **Establish CONTRIBUTORY.md:**
    - Create CONTRIBUTORY.md in the repo root.
    - Content: Extract the strict logic and workflow rules from CONTRIBUTING.md, stripping all human-centric narrative ("Welcome," "You're allowed to be clever").
    - This file serves as the high-density instruction set for AI agents.
6. **Refine AGENTS.md (Axiomatic Density):**
    - Remove narrative justifications, specifically the phrase "This ensures rhythmic precision for technical auditing."
    - Ensure all directives are strictly imperative.

Required Content (optional; use when doc/governance changes demand exact text/format):

- CONTRIBUTORY.md must strictly follow the format of AGENTS.md (Axiomatic/Boolean).

3.4.3 Changelog

- **Log (human-readable, 1–6 bullets):**
    - Refactored ops/bin/llms to use manifest-driven logic and support --profile.
    - Updated ops/bin/open to support --agent persona loading.
    - Implemented ops/bin/project as the primary Project Binary Interface.

    - Created CONTRIBUTORY.md for high-density agent instructions.
    - Purged narrative justification from AGENTS.md.
    - Aligned project library templates (STELA.md, SCAFFOLD.md) with the new binary.

3.4.4 Patch / Diff

- **Format:** Unified diff (preferred) or anchored snippets.

3.4.5 Receipt (Required)

Verification (MUST RUN; or report NOT RUN + reason + risk)

- ./ops/bin/dump --scope=platform (or repo-correct equivalent when scope differs)
- If dump refiners are used, include this fallback line in the DP:
    - Fallback:./ops/bin/dump --scope=platform --format=chatgpt --out=auto --bundle
- **Zero-Byte Check:** Verify dump is not empty (test -s <path>).
- Context lint (use repo-canonical command):
    - Prefer: bash tools/lint/context.sh
    - If not found and required: **STOP** and ask (do not invent a substitute)
- Truth lint (when TRUTH/canon surfaces touched; use repo-canonical command):
    - Prefer: bash tools/lint/truth.sh
    - If not found and required: **STOP** and ask (do not invent a substitute)

Skill capture (required during normal DP processing)

- Workflow: run ops/lib/scripts/skill.sh harvest to auto-generate a draft with provenance and semantic collision checks.
- Review: inspect the draft in storage/handoff/ for heuristic accuracy (Hot Zone and High Churn). Refine Invocation guidance and Solution. Do not edit the Provenance block.
- Promote: run ops/lib/scripts/skill.sh promote <draft_path> or log "no new skill promoted" with a rationale in RESULTS.
- Legacy capture is forbidden. Do not manually write skill files; the provenance block is required.
- If a DP requires skill capture, the DP Target Files allowlist must include SKILL.md.
- Proof required in RESULTS:
    - Harvest-only: command invoked plus draft path and ls storage/handoff/ output.
    - Promotion: command invoked plus grep -n "Promotion Packet:" SKILL.md and grep -n "docs/library/skills/S-LEARN-" docs/library/INDEX.md.

Artifact bundle (required directory)

- storage/handoff/

Proof bundle checklist (required; naming pattern over exact names)

- storage/handoff/DP-OPS--RESULTS.md (required)

- storage/handoff/OPEN-PORCELAIN-[work-branch]-[hash].txt (required)
- storage/handoff/OPEN-[work-branch]-[hash].txt (required)
- storage/dumps/dump-full-... (or platform scope as applicable)
- git diff --name-only (include in RESULTS)
- git diff --stat (include in RESULTS)
- NEXT: one single action (include in RESULTS)

MANDATE: No receipt/proof bundle = **AUTOMATIC DISAPPROVAL**.

Closeout routine receipts not being produced CONSISTENTLY INCLUDING PORCELAIN, DUMP AND OPEN is a failure condition.

Partial receipts (e.g., missing OPEN artifacts when a session was started) are considered failures.

REQUIRED OUTPUT

MUST include a "Status" block at the top of RESULTS:

- Scope summary: (1 sentence validating the loop)
- Tracked change: (What was edited)
- Verification: (Output of proofs)

RESULTS file must include (minimum)

- Verification results (RUN/NOT RUN + reason + risk)
- Patch/diff proof bundle (status/diff list or direct diff)
- Receipt pointers (OPEN + PORCELAIN + DUMP outputs/paths)
- git diff --name-only output
- git diff --stat output
- NEXT: one single action

Storage artifact flow (local-only, untracked):

- OPEN and OPEN-PORCELAIN outputs land in storage/handoff/.
- Dump bundles land in storage/dumps/.
- Results receipts land in storage/handoff/DP-OPS-0000-RESULTS.md (pattern).
- Operator stores DP drafts under storage/dp/intake/ and moves or copies to storage/dp/processed/ after completion (or when reusing a previously executed DP).
- These are retention paths only; they are not worker prerequisites unless the DP explicitly says so.

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4. Closeout (Mandatory)

Worker closeout duties (end of session)

- [ ] Produce/Update: storage/handoff/DP-OPS--RESULTS.md
- [ ] If canon/governance surfaces were changed, include **SoP.md** in scope and update it in the same PR slice.
- [ ] Run ops/bin/prune (hygiene).
- [ ] Run ops/bin/llms (refresh context bundles).
- [ ] Ensure proof bundle checklist is satisfied (above). (No bundle = DISAPPROVE.)
- [ ] Fill out the Mandatory Closing Block (see below).
- [ ] Append a **TASK Work Log** entry (below) capturing:
  - what changed (high level)
  - gates/verification outcome (pass/fail or not run + reason)
  - blockers (if any)
  - **NEXT:** one single action

Mandatory Closing Block (Varied Wording Required)

Varied Wording provision: Each entry must use meaningfully distinct wording; copy or minor tense changes are not acceptable. Entry 4 must differ from Entry 1.

1. Primary Commit Header (plaintext)
2. Pull Request Title (plaintext)
3. Pull Request Description (markdown)
4. Final Squash Stub (plaintext) (Must differ from #1)
5. Extended Technical Manifest (plaintext)
6. Review Conversation Starter (markdown)

Integrator/operator closeout duties

- [ ] Review diff vs DP scope/forbidden zones
- [ ] Run repo-gates / required checks
- [ ] Commit/push/open PR/merge (operator-controlled)

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6. Future Findings and Next Phase Integration

The execution of DP-OPS-0021 will officially inaugurate Phase 3: The Project Binary Era. This transition shifts the governance focus from "Static Hygiene" to "Dynamic Orchestration."

6.1 The Jurisdictional Paradox: Platform vs. Payload

The core question posed by the architecture is: *"How does Stela maintain jurisdictional authority in both a construction environment while maintaining fidelity to the purpose of the Stela system?"*

The answer lies in the concept of the **Context Membrane**.[7] In a "projects factory" model, the Platform (ops/) represents the "Means of Production," while the Payload (projects/) represents the "Product." Authority is not maintained by imposing the Platform's content upon the Payload, but by imposing the Platform's *process* upon the Payload's lifecycle.

- **Jurisdiction:** The Platform holds jurisdiction over the *Container* (Git hooks, project binary, CI/CD gates). The Payload holds jurisdiction over the *Content* (application logic).
- **Fidelity:** Fidelity is maintained because the project binary enforces TRUTH.md as the "Ring 0" constraint in every context window. Even when an agent works on a project, the "Constitution" is present. The projects/<ID>/STELA.md file acts as a "Local Bylaw" that can refine, but not contradict, the Constitution.

6.2 Semantic Saturation and Axiomatic Risk

The removal of narrative buffers in AGENTS.md creates a state of **"Semantic Saturation"**.[2] While this optimizes the Token-Utility Curve, it removes the "soft landing" for misinterpretation.

- **Risk:** A literalist agent might interpret "Anti-Drift Governance" so strictly that it blocks valid refactoring.
- **Mitigation:** We must monitor the "Questions/Clarifications" frequency in agent logs. A spike indicates that the axioms are too abstract (Economy of Scarcity) rather than efficiently compressed (Economy of Truth).

6.3 The Manifest Dependency Risk

By linking ops/bin/llms to ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md, we create a rigid dependency chain. If the manifest is syntactically invalid, the context generation—and thus the autopoietic loop—will fail.

- **Next Phase Requirement (DP-OPS-0022):** Introduce tools/lint/manifest.sh to validate the syntax and integrity of all manifests (Context, Project, and future Bundle manifests) before they are consumed by the binaries.

6.4 The Evolution of Roles and Tasks

The query posits: *"Maybe the DP template in TASK is just another TASK... and maybe the roles are just 3 more variations."* This insight aligns with **Neuro-Symbolic** architectural patterns.[8] As Stela evolves, the distinction between a "System Role" (Integrator) and a "Library Role" (Architect) blurs. They are all simply *personas* instantiated by the ops/bin/open membrane to manipulate the state of the repository.

- **Future Vision:** A unified "Agent Registry" where AGENTS.md and docs/library/agents/ merge into a single ops/lib/manifests/AGENTS.md, dynamically loadable by the project binary based on the complexity of the Dispatch Packet.

This analysis confirms that DP-OPS-0021 is not merely a tooling update, but a fundamental

re-architecture of how the system perceives and enforces its own reality. By reifying the Project Binary and purging the last vestiges of narrative fluff, we align Stela with the rigorous demands of High-Density Governance. The system is no longer just a repository; it is a machine that manufactures compliant software.

Works cited

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